

levels of exposure, highlighting the expanding abilities of GenAI technology to potentially automate more specialized tasks in professional and technical roles.

Overall, the revised global employment estimates of GenAI exposure are lower than in our 2023 paper, though still, one in four jobs globally (24%) has some degree of exposure, and one in three jobs in high-income countries. What is particularly striking is the continued association of gender with occupations with higher levels of exposure, especially in higher-income countries. Compared to 7.8% of female employment and 2.9% of male employment in high-income countries classified as having high automation potential in 2023, the current study increases these figures to 9.6% for females and 3.5% for males, respectively.

Notwithstanding these findings, we stress that such exposure does not imply the immediate automation of an entire occupation, but rather the potential for a large share of its current tasks to be performed using this technology. Whether this leads to the disappearance of an occupation or workforce replacement is a more complex question – one that will depend on the initial decision to adopt the technology, but also the extent to which individuals in these occupations are given opportunities to learn to work with these technologies and adapt to the evolving nature of their tasks. As argued by numerous economists, the key to unlocking the productivity benefits of GenAI lies not in the search of outright labour savings, but in the extent to which human expertise can be complemented with new technological capacities to reshape occupations and generate additional value-added (Acemoglu, 2024; Autor, 2024).

Ensuring such positive synergies necessitates an approach to technology's adoption at the workplace that is human-centered. With one in four workers across the world in an occupation with some degree of GenAI exposure, there is need to ensure that the transition is managed through social dialogue, both to minimize “technological unemployment” and the hardship associated with it, but also to ensure that for the majority who remain employed, the technology is implemented in a way that supports them in carrying out their jobs. Workers know their jobs best and can play an important role in the design, adaptation and use of the technology at the workplace, to the benefit of both working conditions and productivity.